

Sarah Lang

HOW TO BEST MAKE USE OF YOUR FOUNDING FATHERS. POLITICAL INSTRUMENTALIZATIONS OF AENEAS FOR CREATING ROMAN IDENTITY IN THE AUGUSTAN TIME



Sarah Lang,

B.A., Mag. phil., student of various fields of the Humanities (including Classics and History) at Graz University since 2011, currently working at the Zentrum für Informationsmodellierung – Austrian Centre for Digital Humanities, Graz.

Contact: sarah.lang@edu.uni-graz.at

Zusammenfassung:

WIE VERWERTET MAN DIE GRÜNDERVÄTER AM BESTEN? POLITISCHE INSTRUMENTALISIERUNGEN VON AENEAS ZUR SCHAFFUNG EINER RÖMISCHEN IDENTITÄT ZUR ZEIT VON AUGUSTUS

Da er über Vergils Epos zu großer Berühmtheit gelangte, wurde über den mythischen Helden Aeneas viel diskutiert. Besonders beschäftigte sich die Forschung mit der innenpolitischen Funktion der *Aeneis* als Nationalepos der Römer und dabei vor allem mit dem Verhältnis zwischen Augustus und dem zu ihm analog gedachten mythischen Vorgänger, wobei die Gründergestalt Aeneas entweder als kritisch vorgehaltenes Spiegelbild oder als Glorifizierung des Herrschers interpretiert wurde, der sich als Neugründer Roms stilisierte. Die propagandistische Instrumentalisierung der Aeneassage als politischer Mythos und außenpolitische Aussage ging neben den anderen Aspekten bislang in der Forschung eher unter. Doch auch der griechische Historiker Dioynsios von Halikarnass nutzte den Mythos des Aeneas, um sich in eine alte, griechisch-basierte, genealogische Forschungstradition um Gründerhelden einzureihen und in der Person des Aeneas Griechen und Römer zu Verwandten verschmelzen zu lassen. Dieser Artikel beschäftigt sich mit der außenpolitischen Funktion der Aeneassage für das Römische Reich, das sich über diese ideologisch in den vormals griechisch dominierten Mittelmeerraum eingliederte, sowie mit der besonderen Eignung des Aeneas als Bild des Proto-Römers.

Rome was founded by Romulus or so says Roman political myth anyway. The most famous national epic although, the Virgilian *Aeneid*, revolves around Aeneas, a Trojan, his journey to Italy and his struggle for homeland. It could be argued, of course, that Romulus had come to be too closely associated with the fratricide of civil war to be used as a flagship of *Romanitas* anymore, but I argue below that the reasons were far more manifold and elaborate and that there is a great deal to be learned from Romans on how to best make use of your founding figures.¹

INTRODUCTION

An article claiming to analyze the political implications of the *Aeneid* might be dismissed by the well-read recipient knowing that the discussion of the political *Aeneid* is at least as old as the *Aeneid* itself, if not older.² In more recent times, German classicists have claimed a propagandistic, even panegyric *Aeneid* whereas American classicists of the Harvard School have long followed Adam Parry in his Two Voices theory claiming Virgil was an

ingenious poet managing to smuggle a profoundly subversive work under the nose of the very emperor it so severely criticizes.³ These interpretations concentrate nearly blindly on the implications of Virgil's poetry on emperor Augustus while I portend that this might have led scholars to overlook other political dimensions of the *Aeneid* as a national myth, providing identity for all Romans and placing them in the political network of the formerly Greek-dominated Mediterranean. Scholars focusing on this masterful, well-known and by far most impactful treatise on Aeneas, the *Aeneid*, overlook the fact that Virgil was by no means the only poet or even scholar treating the said myth. In Augustan time, there was already a broad base of scholarly research providing a plethora of theories on the pre-Roman-ness of Aeneas and on how it could be used as a link between the Trojan War, the very event every respectable city in a Greek dominated world had to relate its founding myths and heroes to, and the foundation of Rome. Ever since the 3rd century BC scholarly endeavors of Roman and Greek scholars alike had established Aeneas as a Roman hero long before Virgil decided to use him for his Roman national epic. While it took until Augustan time for the myth to be fully established and popularized as one of Rome's founding tales, its popularity has never faded until today, thanks mainly to the Virgilian epic. However, even in Augustan time, the myth of Aeneas was not used by Virgil alone, it also had its place in visual forms of propaganda such as the *ara pacis*. It appears in the historical treaties of Livy who dismisses it as pure myth too prehistoric for his work and Dionysius of Halicarnassus who uses it to establish a direct genealogical relationship from Greek ancestors to modern Romans, thus making Rome Greek. Ovid too, within his famous *Metamorphoses*, presents his take on the Virgilian epic in the form of a somewhat smaller *Aeneid*. The following aims at historically tracing the establishment of Aeneas as a Roman hero from the first endeavors to its successful implementation and to analyze what use was made of the political myth created in the process.

THE MAKING OF A HERO: HOW POLITICAL MYTH WAS USED IN ANTIQUITY

In Antiquity, myth was, at least in part, thought to be historical and even if an Augustan period scholar might not have believed in the exact wording, as

Livy hints in the foreword to his history of Rome⁴, the history of one's own beginnings has been and will always be important for any political entity to give identity and generate a sense of unity among a people. These mythical beginnings were perceived as more than mere fables, possessing a historicity of their own. It has to be added here, however, that not every myth was perceived as true: the half-mythological Roman kings were accepted to be almost entirely historical (which a modern day historian would most certainly doubt) but anything before Romulus fell into the realm of less believable fables. Moreover, there was a difference between etiological recounts of the founding of cults (called *aition*, pl. *aitia*) and the founding myths of cities (called *ktiseis*).⁵ Cult founding myths were understood as mere symbols for the connection to the Gods, but the beginnings of cities, even if there was no historical proof and these stories seem to us no less mythical than the cult *aitia*, were perceived as historical events. These borders were often blurred because of the person a myth was linked to: a founder was a mythological figure, a hero, but also someone to whom cult *aitia* were attributed.⁶



Aeneas carrying his father Anchises on his shoulders holding the household gods, as they escape from the sack of Troy. Mixed method print by Elisha Kirkall, 1722, after Ugo da Carpi, 1518, after Raphael. Source: https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/f/f7/Aeneas_carrying_his_father_Anchises_on_his_shoulders_holding_Wellcome_V0039202.jpg.

The myths of Classical Antiquity were not simple children's stories or elements of popular culture. Quite the opposite, almost all of them had a second layer of meaning as political myths.⁷ Even if at the beginning they might have been children's stories, their contents and meanings were changed entirely by their instrumentalization and use in political contexts. These myths function so well as identification for a people because they are always centered on a leader, a singular person, an individual carrying the fate of a nation. Thereby, they can be used for political legitimization just as well as for personal national identity and, more importantly, as parallels to political leaders using them. Mythical heroes are exemplary figures and thus can prefigure a political leader in an ideological way or even come to represent a national personification as the Trojan Aeneas came to be the exemplary proto-Roman.⁸

Myth is very much fit for political propagandistic use because mythological narratives function in the same way as political ones do. A hero, just like a political leader, is in fact not really an individual: he is a mere carrier of his main characteristics that are used in a symbolic way. If the most prominent characteristic of Aeneas is his fatherly pietas (piety), then with Romulus it is his youth and dynamics. To subsequently generate a narrative, a standard plot and character elements (topoi) are combined so as to create a story, just like any politician would do in his propaganda.⁹ Aeneas is a prototypical personification of his main characteristic which also explains the fact that certain theories (like the Two Voices theory) criticize him for having neither an actual personality nor a real life of his own. In his function as the leader of a people, his private life is significant for the state, everything he does will shape the future of Rome, all his words are prophetic, his actions symbolic. He practically is (symbolic of) the state, a burden that quite naturally is hard to bear, almost too big for a single individual alone. This mechanism of putting symbolic values in a narrative is used by politicians to create political myths for contemporary history: it is not even in question whether a leader stylizing himself as wise or heroic acts more or less wisely or heroically in a given situation. The mythological symbols and heroic topoi are used to create a general image. The symbols themselves only need an added narrative to become (political) myths. Tonio Hölscher calls this a mythification of the present in political myths as for example the image of the emperor

(princeps) created by and for Augustus, based on the prototypical mythical parallels of Aeneas and Romulus.¹⁰

HEROIC GENEALOGIES AND THE POLITICAL IDENTITY OF POLEIS IN THE GRECO-ROMAN MEDITERRANEAN

Quite apart from that, tracing back the roots of a city to a (preferably Homeric) mythological hero was not only a symbolic act executed by a city, it generated a whole science of genealogy, for in Greek culture, mythological heroes were thought to be connected with the noblemen of their own time in a direct blood relationship. In Greek genealogy, these genealogical efforts were taken very literally.¹¹ In the Roman tradition of the Augustan period, they tended to converge with the tradition of Roman exempla, outstanding heroes of early Roman history, into a linking by analogy rather than actual blood relationships. This change in use of mythological heroes seems to have happened between Caesar who still claimed to be a direct heir of Venus, following the genealogical line of Aeneas' son Iulus, the founder of Caesar's gens Iulia, and Augustus, whose funerary procession did not include a mask of Aeneas, pointing to the fact that Augustus did not in fact claim a blood relationship to Aeneas¹² even though at this time the Virgilian *Aeneid* providing a plethora of glorious parallels between Augustus and Aeneas had already come to its great fame.



Roman coin showing the landing of Aeneas in Italy. Source: https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/b/b5/Dictionary_of_Roman_Coins.1889_P17S0_illus026.gif.

Dynastical connections in Antiquity had something to do with blood relationships and legitimation of power but the descriptive aspect of dynastic genealogical lines was of greater importance: a modern-day political leader had to have a lot in common with a mythological or historical leader just because they shared the same role in the state. Augustus was not the real son of Caesar and the act of adopting him had nothing to do with fatherly feelings: it was an act of creation of dynastic lines. Caesar and Augustus were related because of the ideological function they shared. There was no need to explain why a leader had achieved his position legitimately or not if he was able to defend it (as Caesar, for example, was not, but Augustus was). By keeping his position, he had already proven himself worthy of the power. It follows that political myth is not so much a means of legitimation of power but rather a simple explanation of the status quo – an act of arranging history to fit the status quo, not to create it.¹³ This, in my opinion, could easily explain the famous end scene of the *Aeneid* where Aeneas kills his enemy Turnus who had previously caused him a lot of trouble but in the moment of his death seemed to regret it. The scene is perceived by some as a scandalous ending to the story of the foundation of the Roman Empire and has been interpreted as the ideological downfall of the leader Aeneas¹⁴, a personification of piety and understanding, in his political triumph. The scene is sometimes understood to mark a parallel between Aeneas and Augustus but in a very critical, almost subversive way, claiming that the leader had his triumph only by perverting his own ideals, but I think the opposite is the case: the scene could serve as a reminder that Caesar showed his enemies too much mercy (he was famous for his *clementia*) and lost his life for it in the end, which would have been perceived as weakness in Roman thinking. After all, the *Aeneid* stresses the Roman motto of “*parcere subiectis et debellare superbos*”¹⁵ and Aeneas triumphs in following it. This scene, viewed as a political myth, could serve to stress that Augustus is not going to make Caesar’s mistakes.

A HERO IN THE MAKING: FROM HEIR OF TROY TO ROMAN FOUNDING FATHER

The myth of Aeneas as a founder of Rome emerges in Greek literature beginning in the 5th century BC, but real efforts in making sense of early Roman history

using the mythological hero Aeneas start between the 4th and early 3rd centuries BC, as Roman elites and scholars begin to join the discussion and show interest in profiting from the mythological base laid out for them by Greek scholars. Early initiatives in that direction included the bridging of the gap between early Rome and Homeric Troy that was the starting point of Aeneas’ travels to Italy, dated at the time at 1184 BC, while the founding of the city of Rome by Romulus was thought to have taken place in 753 BC. The annalist Quintus Fabius Pictor added the list of Alban Kings in order to connect Rome with the mythological repertoire of the Mediterranean (and by that, meaning a Greek dominated Mediterranean), centered around Homeric Troy and the homeward journeys of heroes involved. It seems, however, that these first efforts on the Roman side were motivated by the evolving Roman scholarship for intellectual reasons more than political ones.¹⁶ The explanations scholars produced were still most welcome with Roman elite families (*gentes*) seeking to trace back their beginnings with mythological heroes in order to claim their rightful place in the political community of Magna Graecia where Rome started to become important: a political partner to be reckoned with.

In the first century BC Rome was established as the dominant global player of the ancient world and the need to connect its mythological beginnings with a globally accepted myth of the Mediterranean became more and more pressing. Romulus had been of great use and identificatory value as the city-God Quirinus watching over the city of Rome. But the Roman Empire had surpassed its original scope of power and authority beyond Latium and Italy by then and was in need of legitimating its dominating role in the global political landscape. A Roman-born hero who founded the city of Rome was now of limited use for a nation consisting, in the 1st century BC already, mainly of newly conquered lands and their local elites who had been granted Roman citizenship. For those new Romans, Aeneas, a refugee¹⁷ and Roman-to-be himself, was of much greater value as a figure of identification.

While it is almost certain that the myth of Aeneas came to Rome via a well-established Greek scholarly tradition of genealogical and ethnographical efforts, and reached Roman *gentes* eager to glorify their own roots through Roman scholars (so to say in a not primarily political way), it should not be forgotten that academic efforts can also be of political significance. The history of the myth of Aeneas shows us the following: first,

Greek scholarship was interested in the growing power of Rome and the Greeks sought to integrate the rising power into their own cultural sphere as an equal member of the global political community in Magna Graecia, even before Romans themselves were interested in “making themselves Greek” (or at least following in the footsteps of Greek culture, the path of which begins with Homer). Roman intellectual elites who developed around the 3rd century BC sought to become part of a Greek scholarly tradition, but at the same time, by this same primarily intellectual effort, tried to secure political prestige for Rome and its nobility that must have, at the time, seen themselves on the same level as Greek nobility in important poleis, and not primarily as parts of a Roman Empire in the making. The more important and powerful Rome became, the stronger was the desire to differentiate one’s nation from the former dominant power of the Greeks.

Secondly, the scholarly efforts that served to establish Aeneas, and thereby Greek mythology, in Roman tradition were the same ones that constituted the first Roman works on their own history, elaborating what Roman-ness consisted of and what made it different from Greek national identity. This happened not by a complete rejection of Greek myth, but by its inclusion in Roman mythology and religious syncretism, which in the end gave the second layer of political meaning to the primary folk tales; a political meaning quite different from the ones Greek myths had within Greek mythological and political frameworks. This syncretism, typical of Roman religious culture, has often been criticized as a lack of original Roman myth but I think this kind of re-use fits precisely the needs of Roman political myth. Rome, after all, never existed in a vacuum. Rome in its singular power only seems like an entity of its own to us in retrospect. Roman political myths connecting the Greek tradition with a newly to be constituted Roman one, show us that the situation was quite the opposite. Rome was not merely a powerful nation that always suffered from Greek cultural superiority until (and even after) they were able to produce high-quality, high-cultural artefacts in their aemulatio of Greek culture, as is stressed in an overly excessive way in modern scholarly literature.¹⁸ Romans did not emulate Greek culture in vain; they were somehow part of Greek culture all along, even if Roman culture might have been looked down upon by the politically devaluated Greeks.

FOREIGN POLICY: CHOOSING AENEAS OVER ROMULUS

Aeneas, the Trojan proto-Roman, especially the Virgilian version of the hero, serves to remind the Romans of their origins: a mixture of locals from Latium and Trojan settlers¹⁹ who, while not actually Greeks themselves, represent a connection to the Greek world and thereby the global perspective of the Mediterranean. The combination of autochthonous culture that was perceived as almost more Roman than Augustan-era Roman-ness (as American Indian culture is perceived almost more genuinely American than modern-day American culture, an analogy already made by Parry) and the inclusion of politically powerful, noble and well-established newcomers from the Greek cultural sphere is what makes the Roman identity construct so unique. It was the Virgilian description that once and for all demonstrated this special character of Roman national culture.²⁰ It is different from Greek political myth in the way that it does not stress the ethnic autochthony of the people but rather the mixture of origins that allows for the addition of new stakeholders of Roman identity as opposed to the exclusivity of Greekness. *Romanitas* consisted in the upholding of the *mos maiorum*, the ancient (almost pre-)Roman tradition based in common moral values rather than language and common linked genealogy based upon mythology, as with Greek identity.²¹

Dionysius of Halicarnassus, a Greek historian working in 1st century BC Rome as a contemporary of the poet Virgil, writes his *Roman Antiquities*, a prehistory and early history of Rome, with the goal of showing that Romans are actually ethnographically a Greek-based nation.²² He writes in Greek for a Greek audience to whom he wants to explain Roman political success and a newly established superiority over Greeks (following his predecessor Polybius), claiming a direct blood relationship between Romans and Greeks. In the political myth he writes, Non-Greeks are assimilated to become Greeks through the etiological hero Aeneas. This is a cultural upgrading for Romans like it is a political one for Greeks whose political supremacy can thus continue with the Romans, who in Dionysius’ interpretatio Graeca of Roman prehistory become their heirs by blood. He goes so far as to argue that even Trojans are actually originally Greek via their fore-father Dardanus from Arcadia.²³ His interpretation of Rome

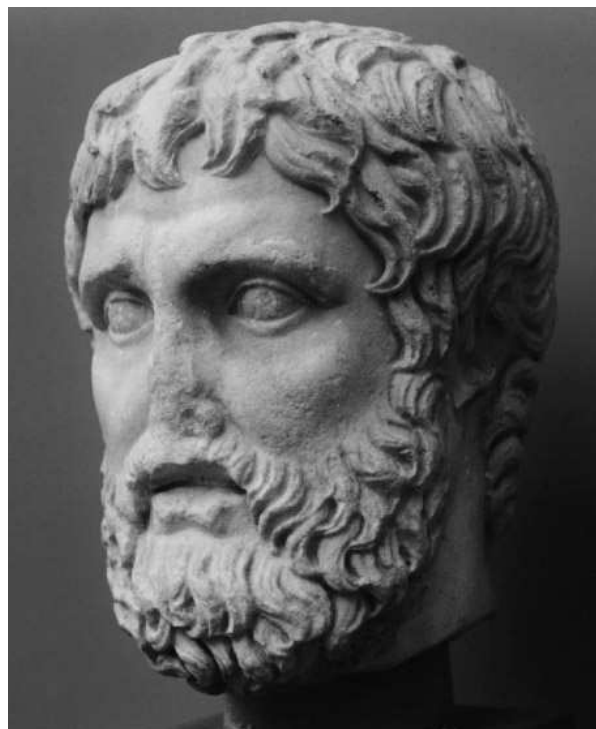
as a Greek town²⁴ coincides with the theory that 3rd century BC scholars started by linking Greece and Rome via Aeneas in order to include Rome in the global Greek Mediterranean politico-cultural sphere. The clarification of genealogical relationships that stood symbolically for political hierarchies was after all an essential part of Greek political culture which can be understood as a primary motivation for the *Roman Antiquities* of Dionysius.²⁵

Thus, if Romans had become politically essential global players, in Greek political ideology it was indispensable that they had an ancestor who was an important noble man in the Trojan War as described in the Homeric hymns. This forefather had to be glorified in the political myth not of the city of Rome for which Romulus was the most important founder, but the Roman Empire as a whole like it would have been expected of any etiological myth of a Greek polis. This mechanism even becomes apparent in the work of Dionysius that in and of itself constitutes an ethnographical approach to the treatment of founding myths and aitia, even if only to use them in his historical approach of rationalized myth in order to create an account of the lost, prehistoric Roman beginnings. The scarcity of original Roman myth allows him to claim a strong Greek inspiration of Roman legislation and culture.²⁶ The use of mytho-historical figures as examples (exempla) in political contexts is typical of Roman political culture and the *Roman Antiquities* of Dionysius represent a work standing in both the Greek ethnographical and the Roman exemplary tradition of writing prehistory.

A NATIONAL PERSONIFICATION

Aeneas was Homeric and Rome's primary founding father Romulus only applied to the city itself, not Italy or the Roman Empire as a whole, with all of its new stakeholders of Roman national identity.²⁷ Romulus, a symbol of *virtus* (virtue), was used to represent the dynamic, young leader, whereas father Aeneas, a symbol of *pietas* (piety), could serve as a pointer to the moral and religious reforms of Augustus.²⁸ Quite apart from that, Aeneas as the proto-Roman was a symbol for unspoiled Romanitas which corresponds exactly with the definition of what Roman *mos maiorum* was all about. Therefore, Aeneas was not only symbolic as a proto-Roman founding father analogous to Augustus as first of the state, but also symbolized the main characteristic element of Roman

culture, the *mos maiorum*, itself. Furthermore, he represents the very first element of Roman history and thereby bridges the gap between Greek history and the beginning of Rome. Virgil's combination of one part *Iliad*, one part *Odyssey* is more than just an act of imitation and emulation, following the great literary example set by Homer.²⁹ It is a narration of *translatio imperii* and constitutes a claim on



Bust of Aeneas. Source: <http://www.maicar.com/GML/000Images/aim/aeneas1636.jpg>.

dynastic continuity. In this respect, Virgil is most innovative presenting the greatest literary reception of the Homeric hymns, combining the Greek cultural, ethnographic, genealogical literary and Roman historiographical traditions as well as providing a narrative of Roman identity, all at the same time.³⁰

Virgil's *Aeneid* is an epic constituting a national political myth in the etiological tradition.³¹ Quite in harmony with the Roman tradition of historical exempla, moral values and correct behavior are conveyed through the fate of a singular, exemplary individual who becomes an identification figure for the present-day leader Augustus just as much as of the Roman people as a nation. The myth of epic deeds and heroes is supposed to give meaning to a nation living hundreds of years later than the mythological peoples involved. By making the heir of Troy a fore-father of Rome, the myth with its long obsolete contents becomes relevant for the Roman nation³², quite like Germanic history – glorified, reduced to

its symbolic values and revived in pseudo-historical mythological, etiological narrations of ancestors and beginnings – came to be relevant and politically usable for Nazi Germany. The *Aeneid* is a political text³³ and while it takes the form of a Greek Homeric epic, it constitutes a historical epic of the Roman tradition at the same time, following in the exemplary tradition of Roman political myth.³⁴

CONCLUSION

Until very recently the German research tradition understood the Virgilian *Aeneid* as a propagandistic epic glorifying Augustus. Quite on the contrary, as detailed above, the use and reception of the ancient myth of one of Rome's founders was not merely meant to glorify the emperor of Rome but in a much broader sense to create the identity of Rome itself as a political entity and new global player of the time. While Caesar's politics were geared very much towards claiming a direct blood relationship between Caesar and Aeneas, the Virgilian epic seems to focus on establishing Augustus as an ideological heir of Aeneas, following the tradition of historical exemplum where analogies were quite sufficient to establish a believable connection between historical, even mythical heroes and present day politics.

The *Aeneid* has so far been understood as a national epic by Romans for Romans, legitimizing the usurpation of power and ruling of the emperor Augustus over the former *res publica*, but we have seen that the idea of the *Aeneid* as a myth from Romans for the global political landscape of the time as foreign policy political propaganda is worth considering. As founding myths, political myths creating national identity are destined for their own people as well as for outsiders to see and accept. By choosing Aeneas over Romulus, Romans make a clear bid for their own insertion into a broader political sphere than the city of Rome or Italy alone, choosing a hero that is not even fully Roman but at the very (mythological) root of the history of the Greco-Roman Mediterranean; a history to be found in the Homeric hymns beginning with the battle of Troy, marking a semi-historical beginning for the historiography of Greco-Roman antiquity from its own inside perspective. If the battle of Troy and the surrounding cycle (*kyklos*) of the myths recounting the homeward journeys of heroes involved, the so-called *nostoi*, is a symbol for

antique world politics, Aeneas (and Rome with him) is shown as a central, essential part, in moral qualities and noble genealogy alike. The *Aeneid*, having had such an enormous impact as part of the world literature, has not really been considered an actual political founding myth meant to position Rome in a global political system of Antiquity. It also deserves recognition as a brilliant incentive in that direction, a means of foreign policy political propaganda so to say, and a precursor of founding myths creating national identities all over the world.

As was pointed out, Virgil was by no means the only author explaining the origins of Rome through Aeneas whose journey from Troy to Italy fit perfectly for usage in the localization of Rome in the "global perspective" of the Mediterranean. Claiming an important position in Greek mythology was a legitimate, even necessary act in showing Rome as an equal to Greece where it was natural for political entities to base their identity and political credibility in their mythological origins and founding figures. This is why the intellectual quest of localizing the very beginnings of Roman genealogy already began in the 3rd century BC when Rome started to become an important power in the antique world. In the 1st century BC, the subject of Aeneas as the beginning of Roman genealogy was discussed in literature, poetry and historical writings alike. Aeneas did not serve as a donor of identity to the Romans themselves only, but, more importantly, through the myth of Aeneas it was possible to include newly conquered areas into the Roman national identity much more easily than through Romulus who was only the founding father of the city. Aeneas, a refugee and Roman-to-be himself, best reflected the needs of new territories trying to find a home in the Roman Empire. If Romulus was the founder of the city of Rome, Aeneas was the father of the Roman Empire. The myth of Aeneas thus served as a political analogy for the leader Augustus, symbol of identification for Romans and new stakeholders of the Roman nation alike and as a means of placing Rome in a legitimate genealogy to claim a position of power in the formerly Greek-dominated Mediterranean. Quite contrary to other national epics, the *Aeneid* was clearly written with a political message. If that message was not the glorification of Augustus, it was certainly a statement on who Romans felt themselves to be, like the Homeric hymns remain for us as points of reference on who Ancient Greeks were.

ENDNOTES

¹ This article is based on my MA thesis: Aeneas wandering, Aeneas transitioning. On the propagandistic use and reception of the wandering myth of the national hero in the Augustan era, as seen in literature as well as political imagery and symbolism (German title: Aeneas' Wanderungen – Aeneas' Wandlungen. Instrumentalisierung der Wandersage um einen Nationalhelden und Aeneas-Rezeption in augusteischer Zeit, im Spiegel von Literatur und Bildsprache), Karl-Franzens-Universität Graz 2017; published under the same title Graz 2017). It represents a study comparing various literary works using the myth of Aeneas in Augustan time and analysing the latter in its historical context, impact and meaning.

² The work was written between 29 and 19 BC and had, at the time Virgil died in 19 BC, already been read out in parts. Cf. Werner Suerbaum, *Vergils Aeneis* (Stuttgart 2007), 110-121.

³ Cf. Ernst A. Schmidt, The Meaning of Vergil's *Aeneid*: The American and German Approaches, in: *The Classical World* 94, No. 2 (2001), 145-171. Adam Parry, The Two Voices of Virgil's *Aeneid*, in: *Arion. A Journal of Humanities and the Classics* 2, No. 4 (1963), 66-80.

⁴ Cf. Livius, *ab urbe condita*, Praefatio (Liv. Praef.).

⁵ Cf. Fritz Graf, Der Mythos bei den Römern. Forschungs- und Problemgeschichte, in: Fritz Graf (ed.), *Mythos in mythenloser Gesellschaft: Das Paradigma Roms* (Stuttgart-Leipzig 1993), 25-44, here 26.

⁶ Danielle Portre, Les trois mythologies des 'Fastes', in: Graf, *Mythos*, 142-157, here 147.

⁷ Cf. Tonio Hölscher, Mythen als Exempel der Geschichte, in: Graf, *Mythos*, 67-87, here 68-70.

⁸ Cf. Suerbaum, *Vergils Aeneis*, 20-25.

⁹ Cf. Hölscher, *Mythen*, 86.

¹⁰ Ibid.

¹¹ When Dionysius of Halicarnassus, for example, shows in his *Roman Antiquities* that Romans are in fact (descended from) Greeks, he means that they are ideological heirs to Greek culture but, most importantly, a blood connection between Romans and Greeks can ethnographically be traced back to Aeneas linking Rome and the Homeric Greek cultural sphere. Cf. Valérie Fromentin, Denys d'Halicarnasse, historien grec de Rome, in: *Histoire et historiographie dans l'Antiquité. Actes du 11ème colloque de la Villa Kérylos à Beaulieu-sur-Mer les 13 & 14 octobre 2000* (Paris 2001), 123-142, here 129-130.

¹² Cf. Egon Flaig, Über die Grenzen der Akkulturation. Wider die Verdinglichung des Kulturbegriffs, in: Gregor Vogt-Spira, Bettina Rommel (eds.), *Rezeption und Identität: die kulturelle Auseinandersetzung Roms mit Griechenland als europäisches Paradigma* (Stuttgart 1991), 81-114, here 88.

¹³ Cf. Hölscher, *Mythen*, 68-70.

¹⁴ Cf. Parry, *Two Voices*, 66-80.

¹⁵ In English: "Pardon the submissive but beat down the rebellious." Vergil, *Aeneid* (Verg. Aen.) VI 853.

¹⁶ Cf. Robert Porod, Hellenistische Konstruktionen eines arkadischen Rom, in: Konferenzband zum Kongress "Arkadien im Altertum. Geschichte und Kultur einer antiken Gebirgslandschaft" Graz 2016 [Draft] (Graz 2017). Jan N. Bremmer, Romulus, Remus and the Foundation of Rome, in: *Bulletin of the Institute of Classical Studies* 34 (1987), 25-48, here 47. Christine Harrauer, Herbert Hunger, Aeneas, in: *Lexikon der griechischen und römischen Mythologie. Mit Hinweisen auf das Fortwirken antiker Stoffe und Motive in der bildenden Kunst, Literatur und Musik des Abendlandes bis zur Gegenwart* (Purkersdorf 2006), 14-16. Ana Rodríguez-Mayorgas, Los orígenes troyanos de Roma: un mito de la historiografía antigua y moderna/The Trojan origins of Rome: A myth of ancient and modern historiography, in: *Revista de Historiografía* 15, No. VIII (2011), 98-108, here 105.

¹⁷ *exsul*, exiled by fate. Verg. Aen. III 11.

¹⁸ Cf. Jan-Wilhelm Beck, Normative Vorgaben und die lateinische Literatur der klassischen Zeit: Römische Originalität und griechische Gattungen, in: Rolf Kussl (ed.), *Altsprachlicher Unterricht. Kompetenzen, Texte und Themen* (Speyer 2012), 145-182, here 145-159.

¹⁹ Cf. Flaig, *Grenzen der Akkulturation*, 86-88.

²⁰ Cf. Porod, Hellenistische Konstruktionen. Parry, *Two Voices*, 68.

²¹ Cf. Greg Woolf, Becoming Roman, Staying Greek: Culture, Identity and the Civilizing Process in the Roman East, in: *Proceedings of the Cambridge Philological Society* 40 (1994), 116-143, here 129f. Greg Woolf explains: "Romans did not conceive of their identity as underwritten by a unique language or a common descent in the same way that some others (including Greeks) did, and their traditions of origin stressed the progressive incorporation of outsiders. Roman identity was based to an unusual degree on membership of a political and religious community with common values and mores (customs, morality and way of life)." Ibid., 120.

²² Cf. Irene Peirano, Hellenized Romans and Barbarized Greeks. Reading the End of Dionysius of Halicarnassus, *Antiquitates Romanae*, in: *Journal of Roman Studies* 100 (2010), 32-53, here 32.

²³ Ibid., 40.

²⁴ Cf. Porod, Hellenistische Konstruktionen.

²⁵ Cf. Nicolas Wiatier, *Dionysius von Halikarnass: Römische Frühgeschichte, Bücher 1-3. Eingeleitet, übersetzt und kommentiert* (Stuttgart 2014), 28-30.

²⁶ Cf. Emilio Gabba, *Dionysius and The History of Archaic Rome* (Oxford 1991), 117-120.

²⁷ Katharine Toll, Making Roman-Ness and the 'Aeneid', in: *Classical Antiquity* 16, No. 1 (1997), 34-56, here 42f.

²⁸ Cf. Jürgen von Ungern-Sternberg, *Römische Studien: Geschichtsbewusstsein – Zeitalter der Gracchen – Krise der Republik* (Leipzig 2006), 73.

²⁹ Though it has to be added that Homer did by no means provide a merely literary work – he like Virgil offered a mythological base for the construction of Greek identities and Virgil followed in his footsteps. Cf. Minna Skafte Jensen, The Homeric Epos and Greek Cultural Identity, in: Lauri Honko (ed.), *Religion, Myth, and Folklore in the World's Epics: The Kalevala and Its Predecessors* (Berlin 1990), 29-48, here 37.

³⁰ On the combination of types of epic (Homeric, Roman historiographical, Hellenistic) in the *Aeneid* cf. Teivas Oskala, Vergil's *Aeneid* as Homeric, National and Universal Epic, in: Honko, *Religion*, 49-72, here 51.

³¹ Cf. Ernst A. Schmidt, Vergils *Aeneis* als augusteische Dichtung, in: Jörg Rüpke (ed.), *Von Göttern und Menschen erzählen: Formkonstanzen und Funktionswandel vormoderner Epik* (Stuttgart 2001), 65-92, here 76f.

³² Cf. Suerbaum, *Vergils Aeneis*, 23-25.

³³ Cf. Christian Siegmund, „Königtum“ in der politischen Kultur des späterepublikanischen Rom (Berlin 2014), 288.

³⁴ Cf. Beck, *Normative Vorgaben*, 162-165.